

Daniel Herrera

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

GIAC-certified cybersecurity student at the SANS Technology Institute with a passion for cybersecurity. I have practical skills in various cyber disciplines such as incident response, windows forensics, packet analysis, and attacker techniques from my various classes, CTFs, and work. Brings a disciplined military background and strong analytical skills to troubleshooting, technical problem-solving, and learning new tools quickly.

COMPETENCIES & SKILLS

Technical: Network analysis, defense-in-depth, incident handling, windows forensics, attacker tactics, techniques and procedures (TTPs), TCP/IP, DNS, Firewalls, access control, basic cryptography, log analysis, group policy, system access and PKI, network hardening, countermeasures, maintaining access (backdoors, trojan horses, rootkits)

Tools:

- **Network Analysis:** Wireshark, tcpdump, Network Miner, Nmap, Masscan, Netcat, Zeek (RITA), Snort, aircrack-ng
- **Penetration Testing & Offensive Security:** Metasploit, BeEF, Responder, FireProx, MSOLSpray, Invoke-MFASweep, ffuf, SQLmap, Commex, BurpSuite
- **Credential & Password Analysis:** Hashcat, John the Ripper
- **SMB/Windows Enumeration:** SMBclient, SMBBeagle
- **Digital Forensics & Incident Response (DFIR):** KAPE, Kansa, Hayabusa, Volatility 3, MemProcFS, Plaso, MFTECmd, EvtxECmd, PECmd, Registry Explorer, Timeline Explorer, Event Log Explorer, AppCompatCacheParser, AmcacheParser, AppCompatProcessor, Autopsy
- **System & Security Utilities:** GPG, Sigcheck, Autoruns, Microsoft Baseline Security Analyzer

Hardware/OS: Windows, Linux

Languages: Python, Bash, basic Powershell

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

SANS Technology Institute, Bachelor of Applied Cybersecurity

December 2026

Hagerstown Community College, Associates of Science, Cybersecurity

December 2024

GIAC Continuous Monitoring Certification (GMON); GIAC Certifications: **GIAC Certified Forensic Analyst (GCFA);** GIAC Certified Forensic Examiner (**GCFE**); GIAC Certified Intrusion Analyst (**GCIA**); GIAC Python Coder (**GPYC**); Certified Incident Handler (**GCIH**); Security Essentials Certification (**GSEC**); Foundational Cybersecurity Technologies (**GFACT**)

CYBER PROJECTS & ENGAGEMENT

NCL Fall 2025:

- Worked through categories such as OSINT, Cryptography, Password Cracking, Log Analysis, Network Traffic Analysis, Forensics, Scanning & Reconnaissance, Web Exploitation, Enumeration & Exploitation.
- Utilized tools such as Bash, Python, Burpsuite, SQLMap, Dev Tools, Wireshark, Network Miner, Autopsy, Nmap, SMBClient, Binary Ninja, Cyber Chef, Volatility, Hex Editors, DB Browser, Hashcat, and many more to solve these various challenges.
- Individual Game: cyberskyline.com/report/85J2L02FKXJ0 | Team Game: cyberskyline.com/report/7KEUFMEGFHPK

NSA Codebreaker 2025: Finished Task 0 - 4

- Mounted ext2 filesystem and performed file forensics to identify anomalous file. Network traffic analysis using wireshark and network miner to discover IPs related to the infected router.
- Discover malicious process using volatility from the infected edge router, extract memfd executable, reverse in BinaryNinja, decrypt the payload, and find all spoofed IPs. Deobfuscate an executable.

Home Lab

- Built and maintained a Proxmox virtualization environment to host services (DNS, Proxy Manager) and isolated vulnerable labs for hands-on testing.
- Deployed and managed containerized applications (Docker) including DVWA (Damn Vulnerable Web App) to practice common web vulnerabilities: XSS, SQL injection, IDOR, directory traversal.
- Built an DFIR AI assistant using VHunter and Gemini through various MCPs while keeping the human in the loop and not giving full access to the AI

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Systems/Network/SharePoint Admin, GCI

2026 – Present

- Built and maintained a locally hosted AI assistant using llama.cpp integrated with cybersecurity-focused MCP servers to support reverse engineering, memory analysis, network traffic analysis, and other security workflows.
- Administered an air-gapped AI environment, developing a package management workflow to securely deploy and maintain required software and dependencies.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to identify operational requirements and develop AI-driven solutions for cybersecurity workflows.

Selector, ADUSA

2022 – Present

- Maintained accuracy and consistency while processing high-volume tasks under strict deadlines.
- Trained and supported new team members by clearly explaining processes and documenting procedures.
- Followed established protocols and safety standards while proactively identifying potential issues.

Infantry, U.S. Army

2019 – 2022

- Held an active Secret Security Clearance and consistently adhered to strict security, confidentiality, and chain-of-custody protocols while handling sensitive information and equipment.
- Led reconnaissance operations and delivered clear, timely intelligence reporting in high-pressure environments, demonstrating strong situational awareness, decision-making, and communication skills.
- Managed and maintained sensitive operational equipment while training team members on safety and compliance procedures, reinforcing accuracy, accountability, and risk-management principles.